

Not All Aces Are Equal

A Data-Driven Comparison of Three NL Cy Young Candidates in 2026

Ohtani · Sanchez · Misorowski

Data Overview

Dataset: 4,797 total pitch events from MLB Statcast (2026 season)

Shohei Ohtani: 1,335 pitches, 14 games, 7 pitch types

Cristopher Sanchez: 1,800 pitches, 19 games, 3 pitch types

Jacob Misorowski: 1,662 pitches, 18 games, 5 pitch types

Key Observation: Ohtani has thrown ~35% fewer pitches than Sanchez.

Despite his two-way role, this workload gap limits overall value.

Pitch Arsenal Comparison

Ohtani: 7 pitch types (FF, SI, ST, FC, CU, FS, SL) — widest arsenal

Sanchez: 3 pitch types (SI, CH, SL) — simple but devastating

Misiorowski: 5 pitch types (FF, FC, CU, SL, CH) — power-based

Key Finding: Sanchez's 3-pitch mix outperforms Ohtani's 7.

- Sanchez SL whiff rate: 42.7% vs Ohtani best (ST): 37.1%
- Sanchez CH whiff rate: 42.0%
- Ohtani ranks LAST in overall whiff rate (28.4%)

Velocity & Movement

Misiorowski: 100.5 mph avg FF (max 105.5 mph) — elite velocity

Ohtani: 98.1 mph avg FF (max 101.7 mph) — elite, but a tier below

Sanchez: 95.2 mph avg SI (max 97.7 mph) — relies on movement, not speed

Sanchez generates extreme horizontal movement: 1.5 in on SI, 1.4 in on CH

Osinkeni has varied movement but lacks the signature ground-ball weapon

Control & Plate Discipline

Key Metric | Ohtani | Sanchez | Misorowski

BB% | 7.6% | 4.8% | 6.4%

K% | 27.9% | 27.6% | 39.6%

K-BB% | 20.3% | 22.8% | 33.2%

Whiff% | 28.4% | 29.7% | 34.3%

Ohtani walks batters at a 58% higher rate than Sanchez.

Misorowski dominates in K% and Whiff% by a wide margin.

Run Expectancy Impact (Critical Finding)

DELTA PITCHER RUN EXPECTANCY (lower = better)

Sanchez: +14.487 total | +0.0080 per pitch ← BEST

Ohtani: +21.028 total | +0.0158 per pitch

Misiorowski: +36.807 total | +0.0222 per pitch

Sanchez gives up HALF the run value per pitch vs Ohtani.

Despite 465 MORE pitches, Sanchez's total run cost is LOWER.

This is the strongest evidence against Ohtani's Cy Young case.

Batted Ball Profile

Metric	Ohtani	Sanchez	Misiorowski
Avg Exit Velo	86.9	89.1	86.6
Hard Hit%	33.8%	44.3%	34.2%
Barrels	0	8	3
Ground Balls	111	192	101

Ohtani suppresses exit velocity well (0 barrels, lower HardHit% than Sanchez)
BUT Sanchez's extreme GB rate (192) creates a different damage profile
Ground balls rarely produce extra-base hits — this is intentional

Platoon Splits

Pitcher	vs LHB OPS	vs RHB OPS
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Ohtani	.545	.383
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Sanchez	.336	.718
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Misiorowski	.288	.554
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Sanchez dominates LHB: 36.2% K%, 1.7% BB%, .336 OPS — elite

Ohtani allows more vs LHB than either peer (.545 OPS)

Misiorowski: 47.6% K% vs LHB is extraordinary

Conclusion

The data does NOT support the claim that Ohtani is the best pitcher of the three.

Sanchez outperforms Ohtani in:

- Walk rate (4.8% vs 7.6% — 58% better control)
- Run prevention per pitch (+0.0080 vs +0.0158 — 50% better)
- Whiff rate on secondary pitches (42.7% vs 37.1%)
- Ground ball generation (192 GB vs 111 GB)
- Durability / workload (1,800 vs 1,335 pitches)

Misiorowski outperforms both in:

- Strikeout rate (39.6%), Whiff rate (34.3%), Velocity (100.5 mph)

Ohtani is excellent, but the numbers say he is the 3rd-best pitcher here.